

pun

The use of a word or phrase that has two or more meanings for comic effect.

question

A sentence that asks for information.

quotation

Text that reproduces another author's exact words, and is written in quotation marks.

quote

To repeat the words of a person.

relative pronoun

A pronoun such as *which* that links one part of a sentence to another by introducing a relative clause, which describes an earlier noun or pronoun.

rhetorical question

A question that does not require an answer but is used for effect.

Roman numerals

Numbers represented by certain letters of the alphabet, such as *i* (one), *v* (five), and *x* (ten).

root

A whole word or part of a word that can attach to a suffix or prefix.

SEO

Standing for "Search Engine Optimization," this is the process that increases the online visibility of a website, so more Web users will visit it.

simile

A phrase that compares one thing to another using *as* or *like*.

slang

Words and phrases that occur in informal speech and are often only used by a select group of people.

slogan

A short but memorable statement that sums up a message.

Standard English

The form of English that uses formal vocabulary and grammar.

statement

A sentence that conveys a fact or piece of information.

subject

The person or thing that is performing the action of the verb.

subjective

When a piece of text is influenced by the writer's personal opinions.

subordinate clause

A group of words that contains a subject and a verb but depends on a main clause for its meaning.

subordinator

A conjunction used to connect words, phrases, and clauses of unequal importance.

suffix

An ending made up of one or more letters that is added to a word to change its form or its meaning.

superlative

The form of an adjective or adverb that suggests the greatest or least of something.

syllable

A unit of pronunciation that has one vowel sound.

synonyms

Words that have the same or similar meanings.

tautology

Saying the same thing more than once using different words.

tense

The form of a verb that indicates the timing of an action.

third person narrative

When an author writes from a detached or outside point of view, using *he/his* or *she/her*.

tone

The feeling or mood projected by a voice: for example, happy, sad, angry, or excited.

transitive verb

A verb that must be used with an object.

verb

A part of speech that describes the action of a noun or pronoun, or a state of being.

vowel

One of the five letters *a*, *e*, *i*, *o*, or *u*.